

The background is a detailed illustration of a Palestinian town, likely Gaza, with the Dome of the Rock visible in the distance. In the foreground, a young boy and girl are standing and looking out over the town. The girl is wearing a red dress with black embroidery, and the boy is wearing a light-colored shirt. They are standing near a large olive tree on the left and a stone wall with a cactus in the foreground.

WORLDLINE KIDS

Lina, Omar & the Olive Tree

A gentle story of Palestine, Gaza, memory and hope

AGES 7-11 • FREE BOOK



A land with a long memory

01

Grandmother tells Lina and Omar that Palestine is a land of old cities, hillside villages, farms and the Mediterranean Sea. Many peoples have lived there across thousands of years. Palestinian families built homes, schools, markets and traditions that are still carried today.

Al-Quds, a city for the world

Al-Quds - Jerusalem - is precious to Muslims, Christians and Jews. Palestinians know East Jerusalem as the capital of their future state. Its final status remains one of the most important questions in the search for a just peace. Grandmother teaches the children to care for every holy place and every neighbor.

Kid note: Caring about one people's rights never requires denying another people's humanity.



The key in the memory chest

03

In 1948, during the Nakba - an Arabic word meaning catastrophe - around 750,000 Palestinians were forced or fled from their homes. Hundreds of towns and villages were emptied or destroyed. Many families kept keys, deeds, photographs and stories. The key in Grandmother's box is a promise to remember.

Life kept growing

Palestinian life is more than a hard history. It is olive harvests, figs and oranges; tatreez embroidery; dabke dancing; stories, books, music, bread and big family tables. Lina learns that culture can travel with people, grow in new places and keep a home present in the heart.



Gaza beside the sea

05

Gaza is a small Palestinian coastal land with ancient roots. Most families there are refugees or descendants of refugees. Children in Gaza study, play football, draw, fly kites and love the sea. They deserve the same safety, freedom and future as every child.

A very hard chapter

Since October 2023, war has devastated Gaza. Many children and adults have been killed or injured, and families have been displaced. Homes, schools and hospitals have been damaged or destroyed. We can tell the truth gently: children are never responsible for war, and every child must be protected.

Grown-ups: pause here, invite questions, and use the source page for current age-appropriate facts.



Planting tomorrow

07

Lina and Omar plant a young olive tree with children in Gaza. A tree cannot repair everything, but it can say: we remember, we care, and we will keep making room for life. Their story ends with a wish - freedom, dignity, safety and equal rights for every child.

For families and teachers

This book is a gentle introduction, not a complete history. Read more together and check current facts. Sources: United Nations - The Question of Palestine (un.org/unispal); UNRWA - Palestine refugees (unrwa.org); UNICEF - Children in the State of Palestine (unicef.org); UNESCO - Jerusalem and cultural heritage (unesco.org).

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